UN Secretariat Efficiencies and Improvements

Work Package 31 | Leads: Under-Secretary-General (DMSPC), Under-Secretary-General (DOS)

OBJECTIVE

To make UN Secretariat administrative services more efficient and effective by reducing duplication and consolidating services.

HOW WE GET THERE

- **Action 94: Implement the efficiency measures already approved** in December 2025 in resolution A/RES/80/242.
- **Action 95: Consolidate other administrative services** such as travel processing, accounts payable, human resources, and ICT so that service delivery is more streamlined.

PROGRESS TO DATE

In 2026, as approved in A/RES/80/242, Common Administrative Platforms (CAPs) were launched in New York and Bangkok to consolidate previously fragmented work. A global payroll processing team was also established in New York, Nairobi and Entebbe to unify this service. Analytical work has been initiated for other administrative service improvements.

NEXT STEPS AND DECISIONS

- **Action 94:** Expansion of CAPs to additional duty stations will continue in 2026–2028, alongside full consolidation of payroll processing in the second half of 2026. Initial progress will be reflected in budget proposals presented to the General Assembly for 2027 and 2028.
- **Action 95:** Analytical work will continue for the consolidation of travel processing, ICT, human resources administration and other administrative processes in 2026. Proposals will be reflected in future budget proposals for consideration of the General Assembly.

QUICK SUMMARY: PATHWAYS AND PRODUCTS

Action	Pathway to decision	Products (dates)	Intergovernmental consideration
Action 94: Implement actions approved in 2026 budget cycle	-	• Progress update in **Proposed Programme Budget** for 2027 and 2028	-
Action 95: Advance services consolidation	Work package leads → Secretary-General → General Assembly	• **Future Proposed Programme Budgets**	For General Assembly decision (eighty-first and eighty-second sessions), as part of the regular programme budget process[2]

ANNEX

A Comprehensive Guide to UN80 Initiative Work Packages

- **Timeline of Expected Products**
- **Intergovernmental Consideration**
- **Endnotes**

Expected timeline of products

	May 2026	June	July	August
Secretary-General's and other official reports, in particular where a decision of an intergovernmental organ is envisaged	• **WP5, 6, 7, 8, 12, 13, 18:** Secretary-General's report on QCPR of operational activities for development of the UN System • **WP5, 6:** UNSDG Chair's report on DCO/RC system • **WP11, 20, 31:** Proposed Programme Budget for 2027 • **WP22:** Secretary-General's report on (UNOCA)	• **WP1:** Secretary-General's peace operations review	• **WP17:** Secretary-General's report (UNITAR/ UNSSC)	
Secretary-General's information briefs, providing further updates and information on specific work packages	• **WP13** Shared Platform Initiative | Action 19 • **WP24** Drugs, Crime, Counter-Terrorism | Action 4: Integration proposal	• **WP2** New Humanitarian Compact | Actions 17, 18, 20, 24 • **WP5** UNCT Reconfiguration | Actions 39, 40: Suppl. info (starting June) • **WP6, 12** Regional Reset | Actions 36, 37, 48, 50: Suppl. info (starting June) • **WP9** Human Rights Group | Action 42 • **WP14, 15** Unified Services Roadmap | Actions 63–67, 61	• **WP1** Peace Operations | Action 14 • **WP7** Joint Knowledge Hubs | Action 33 • **WP15** Technology | Action 62 • **WP17** Training and Research| Actions 69, 72 • **WP18** Funding Mechanisms | Actions 76–78, 91 • **WP21** System-wide Results-Management | Action 93 • **WP22** Peacebuilding | Action 55 • **WP28** Other UN Secretariat Realignments | Action 31	
Operational tools and products, including online platforms, registries, analytical tools and operational guidance	• **WP19** Mandate Creation Support | Action 80, 81, 83 • **WP30** Secretary-General's Reports | Action 87	• **WP14** Unified Services Roadmap | Action 63, 65 Dashboard • **WP29** Mandate Registries and Tools | Action 79, 82 (starting June) • **WP30** Secretary-General's Reports | Action 85		

September	October	November	December	Later or TBD
		• **WP25:** Secretary-General's report on UNAIDS	• **WP5:** Secretary-General's report on the financing and governance of the RC system	• **WP3:** Secretary-General's report (UNDP/UNOPS) • **WP4:** Secretary-General's report (UNFPA/UN Women) • **WP23:** Secretary-General's report (UNIDIR/ODA) • **WP23, 24, 31**: Proposed Programme Budget for 2028
• **WP2** New Humanitarian Compact | Actions 22, 23, 25 • **WP8** Expertise-on-Demand | Actions 34, 54 • **WP16** UN System Data Commons | Actions 74, 75 • **WP27** Environment | Action 35 • **WP28** Other UN Secretariat Realignments | Action 30	• **WP10** Senior Management Coordination Fora | Actions 43, 44, 46 • **WP20** Budget and Programme Management | Action 88			• **WP2** New Humanitarian Compact | Action 16: Finalized 2026 Humanitarian Needs and Response Plans (HNRPs) available online • **WP13** Shared Platform Initiative | Action 57
• **WP16** UN System Data Commons | Action 73				

Intergovernmental consideration

Actions for which intergovernmental consideration is envisaged at this stage

Count	Work Package	Action	Action Text
1	WP1	**Action 15**	Conduct a comprehensive review of the future of United Nations peace operations
2	WP3	**Action 26**	Conduct an evidence-based assessment of the potential benefits of a merger between UNDP and UNOPS
3	WP4	**Action 27**	Conduct a thorough assessment of the potential benefits of a merger of UNFPA and UN Women
4	WP5	**Action 39**	Develop proposals to reconfigure UN country teams
5	WP5	**Action 40**	Strengthen the Resident Coordinator system
6	WP6, 12	**Actions 36, 48, 50**	Develop proposals for a regional reset
7	WP6	**Action 37**	Locate regional capacities more systematically in the premises of Regional Commissions
8	WP11	**Action 45**	Review special envoy, representative, coordinator and adviser roles as part of the regular programme budget process
9	WP17	**Action 68**	Merge UNSSC into UNITAR
10	WP18	**Action 91**	Develop a more coherent Funding Compact review architecture
11	WP19	**Action 80**	Strengthen Secretariat support to Member States through Ad Hoc Working Group on Mandate Implementation Review
12	WP19	**Action 83**	Enhance information on programme budget implications through Ad Hoc Working Group on Mandate Implementation Review
13	WP22	**Action 9**	Streamline and align UNOCA and the Office of the Special Envoy for the Great Lakes
14	WP23	**Action 5**	Integrate UNIDIR into ODA
15	WP24	**Action 4**	Integrate UNICRI into UNODC
16	WP25	**Action 29**	Develop and implement a transition plan to sunset the Joint UN Programme on HIV/AIDS, UNAIDS
17	WP29	**Action 82**	Develop additional digital tools
18	WP30	**Action 85**	Review overlap and fragmentation in reporting and submit proposals through Ad Hoc Working Group on Mandate Implementation Review
19	WP31	**Action 95**	Consolidate other administrative services as part of the regular budget process

Endnotes

Endnote 1: Pathways to decision
References to pathways reflect the next steps currently anticipated on the basis of information available at the time of publication. They may be updated as work package proposals are further developed.

Endnote 2: Budget process
Where proposals are expected to be reflected in the proposed programme budget or related budget documentation, consideration and decision-making would take place through the regular budget process, in accordance with applicable rules and procedures.

Endnote 3: Dashes in the tables
A dash (-) in a table indicates that, based on information available at the time of publication:

- no specific consideration or decision by an intergovernmental organ has been identified,
- no product has been identified, or
- a decision has already been taken and no further decision is envisaged.

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